

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A J 9 2
 ♥ 10 7 5 3
 ♦ A 4 2
 ♣ 9 7

♠ 6 4

♥ K Q 2

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 8 7

♥ 9 6 4

♦ 8 7 5

♣ 10 6 4

♠ K 5 3

♥ A J 8

♦ Q 9 6

♣ Q J 5 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

♠ 7 hold the trick. He will continue the suit, allowing you to pick up dummy's ♠ K and four ♠ winners. Along with the ♦ A you will defeat the contract.

[showcards W:S7 N:S3]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠ 7, dummy played the ♠ 3

Play the ♠ 2.

Partner has led a small card, so it is surely fourth-down. That means you should automatically apply the Rule of Eleven.

11 minus 7 equals 4, so there are just 4 cards higher than the 7 between dummy, you, and declarer. **AND YOU CAN SEE ALL FOUR OF THEM.**

Declarer has no card that can beat the ♠ 7, and the only way you can beat this contract is to let partner's

If you play ANY card except your ♠ 2 on the first trick you will not be able to win four tricks in the suit because you cannot get East back into the lead. And declarer will make the contract easily.

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3
 ♥ 8 2
 ♦ 10 9 5 4 2
 ♣ K 8 6 3

♠ K 10 7 5

♥ 6

♦ K 8 3

♣ Q J 9 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6 4

♥ K 10 9 7 4 3

♦ A Q 7

♣ A 10

♠ A Q J 8 2

♥ A Q J 5

♦ J 6

♣ 7 4

West	North	East	South
		1♥	1♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

[showcards W:H8 N:H6]

The bidding has been as shown. North's 2♥ bid shows good ♠ support with at least 10 points.

Partner led the ♥8, dummy played the ♥6

Play a small ♥.

Partner's ♥8 lead is a high spot card, either top-of-nothing, or a singleton or doubleton. He definitely does not have an honor, which means that South holds ♥ A Q J.

In other words, your ♥K is dead in the water. BUT, if you play it to this trick you hand South three ♥ tricks, while if you play a low ♥ he can only get 2 winners in the suit.

The extra winner would permit South to discard 2 of dummy's ♦ losers, and this would give South the contract.